

JAVAZONE 2026

AI is *easy*. Trustworthy data is *hard*.

Why data engineers matter more than ever

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THE QUESTION EVERY BUSINESS IS ASKING

"What can **AI**
do for us?"

The low hanging fruit: AI Analyst

Chat directly with your data warehouse. Every major platform ships one now.



Snowflake

CoCo Analyst



Databricks

AI/BI Genie



BigQuery

Gemini in BigQuery

The upside is real



Accessible

Data opens up to the whole organisation



Fast

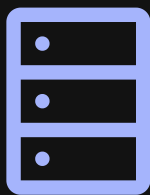
Insights in seconds, not sprint cycles



Self-serve

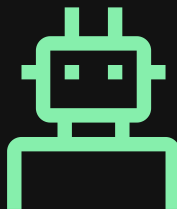
Your CFO can just ask

How these solutions works under the hood is much like a sandwich store.



Ingredients

Your data



The Chef

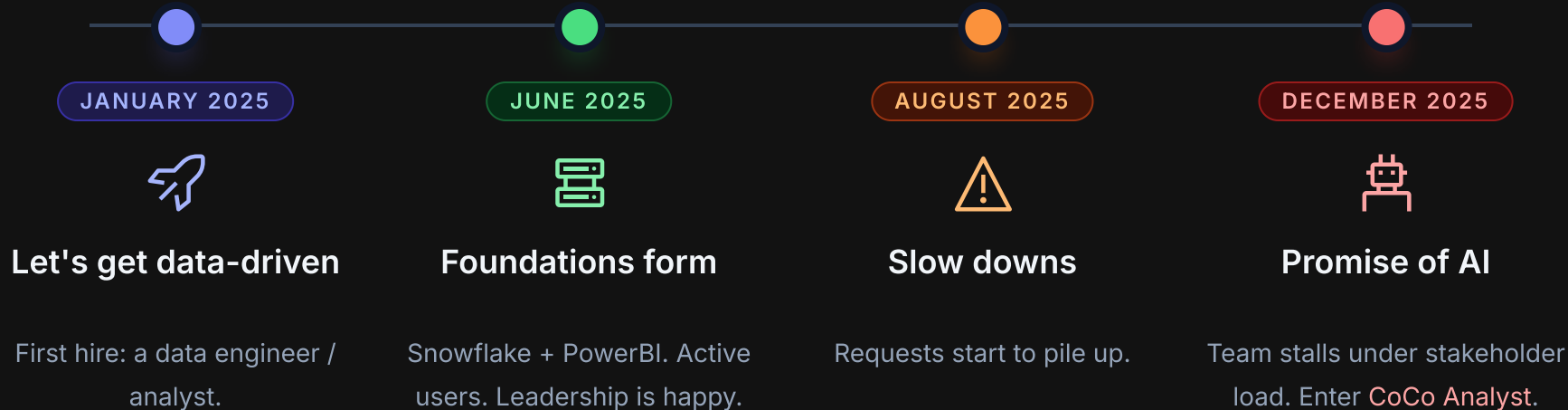
The AI model



The Customer

The business user

How we ended up adopting AI analytics



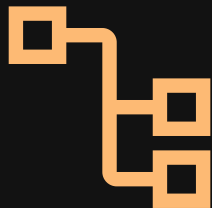
The road ahead for our AI analyst



Pitfall 1: The warehouse wasn't built to be read by strangers

abc

Naming



Structure



Documentation

Pitfall 2: Diverging definitions



AUGUST 2025

One definition

Both definitions gathered and consolidated into a single shared one.



+ 6 MONTHS

Quiet drift

Marketing team adds "Has been online in the last 10 days" rule to Active Users



+ 12 MONTHS

Two truths

13k vs 55k

Same word. Two numbers. Everyone thinks they agree.

Pitfall 3: Lack of data quality checking



AI catches broken data

Nulls, types, freshness, outliers



Only humans catch wrong data

A clean number telling a lie

The core insight



None of these problems are new.

AI is an amplifier: it makes them faster, louder, and harder to catch.

We end up in these situations when we don't understand data development processes

■ Coding ■ Architecture ■ Stakeholder work

PERCEIVED



ACTUAL



TAKE ONE STEP BACK

"Which metrics
do we trust today?"

The order that actually works



Schema + Quality

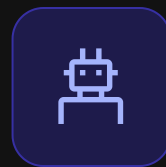
FOUNDATION



Agreed metrics



Trusted dashboards



AI on top

CAPSTONE

You can't skip a step.

Take this home: Rigoursly test your project with this checklist

- 1 Can a stranger read the schema?
- 2 Is there one definition per metric?
- 3 Does the data match your expectations?
- 4 Can every number trace back to its source and its consumers?

**The AI you want is often a dashboard
you'd believe.**

Thank You

Questions?



VegSja



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